

**Kindergarten
Ontario Curriculum
Foundations of Language and
Mathematics — Number Sense
and Operations**

The Coin Counters

Unit Overview: The Coin Counters

Grade: Kindergarten | **Strand:** Foundations of Language and Mathematics — Number Sense and Operations

Target Expectations: A6.7, A6.8, A6.9, A6.10, A6.11, A6.12, A6.13

Learning Goal: Children will estimate quantities and check by counting, count to 20 from any starting number, recall addition and subtraction facts to 5 and solve concrete situations to 10, share fairly using objects, and identify the Canadian penny, nickel, dime, and quarter and their values to 25¢.

Lesson	Lesson Title	Learning Goal
Day 1	How Many in the Jar?	I can guess how many pennies are in a jar, then count to check, and I can count to 20 starting from any number.
Day 2	Plus and Minus to 5	I can say all the ways to make 5 with two groups, and I can say what is left when I take some away.
Day 3	Snack Shop Story Problems	I can listen to a snack-shop story, act it out with cubes, and tell how many are altogether or how many are left.
Day 4	Sharing Fairly	I can share a small group of things equally onto plates so each plate has the same amount.
Day 5	Penny, Nickel, Dime, Quarter	I can name the four Canadian coins to 25¢ and tell how much each one is worth, and I can pick coins to pay for a snack priced 5¢, 10¢, or 25¢.

Lesson 1: How Many in the Jar?

Goal: Before we count, we can make a smart guess about how many — that is called an estimate.

Expectation: A6.7, A6.8

Learning Goal: "I can guess how many pennies are in a jar, then count to check, and I can count to 20 starting from any number."

Materials: M1_canadian_coins, M2_estimation_jar

1. Minds On (10 mins): Quincy's Penny Jar

Today we welcome Penny, Nick, and their piggy-bank friend Quincy to our classroom. Quincy is FULL of pennies — but he wants to know HOW MANY. Could you make a smart guess?

Bring children to the carpet with Quincy propped beside the class jar.

2. Action (20 mins): Coin Path and Mini-Jar Counts

- Whole group: walk the Coin Path.
- Send pairs back to their tables.
- Circulate with the diagnostic checklist.

3. Consolidation (10 mins): Smart-Guess Wall

Discuss:

- When you looked at the jar, what helped you make a smart guess?
- Penny says she always counts on instead of starting over at 1.

Exit: Refrain chant 3x.

Lesson 2: Plus and Minus to 5

Goal: Two small groups together make 5. Take some away — a smaller group is left.

Expectation: A6.11

Learning Goal: "I can say all the ways to make 5 with two groups, and I can say what is left when I take some away."

Materials: M3_linking_cubes, M4_ten_frames

1. Minds On (10 mins): Penny's Cube Train

Penny has 5 snap-cubes for the snack shop — but they come in two colours. How many ways can she put them together?

Bring children to the carpet. Hold up Penny and 5 large foam cubes (3 red, 2 yellow).

2. Action (20 mins): Partner Hunt — Building the Bonds of 5

- Whole group: each child gets 5 snap-cubes (mixed red and yellow).
- Class fills the Partners-of-5 chart together.
- Introduce subtraction.
- Send pairs to their tables for the Partner Hunt game.
- STRATEGY COMPARE: Pause the game.
- Circulate to record formative evidence on the Partners-of-5 tracker.

3. Consolidation (10 mins): The Partners-of-5 Song

Discuss:

- What was your favourite partner of 5?
- If 5 cubes are on the table and 4 are showing, how many are hiding?
- Why do we say plus and minus are friends?
- Can you think of partners for a number that ISN'T 5?

Exit: Refrain chant 3x.

Lesson 3: Snack Shop Story Problems

Goal: If more comes in, we add. If some leaves, we subtract. Stories tell us which one.

Expectation: A6.12

Learning Goal: "I can listen to a snack-shop story, act it out with cubes, and tell how many are altogether or how many are left."

Materials: M1_canadian_coins, M3_linking_cubes, M4_ten_frames

1. Minds On (8 mins): Penny's First Customer

A customer walks up to Penny's snack shop with a problem — and the answer is hiding inside a story.

Bring children to the carpet. Hold up Penny and a small pile of 7 pennies.

2. Action (22 mins): Listen, Act, Solve — Whole Group then Stations

- Whole group: read three more stories together.
- Build the keyword chart together.
- Send children to three rotating stations: (a) Cube Station with picture-card stories and snap-cubes; (b) Coin Station with picture-card stories and real Canadian pennies; (c)...
- STRATEGY COMPARE: After station rotation, gather the class.
- Mid-unit formative check (after Lesson 3 only): hand out the 3-prompt 'Numerals 0–10 Check-In' worksheet.

3. Consolidation (10 mins): Tell Your Own Story

Discuss:

- When you were at the stations, what was a word that told you to ADD?
- What was a word that told you to TAKE AWAY?
- Penny had 4 cubes and Nick took 1.
- Can you tell us your OWN snack-shop story?

Exit: Refrain chant 3x.

Lesson 4: Sharing Fairly

Goal: Fair shares means every plate gets the same. We deal one at a time until they are gone.

Expectation: A6.9

Learning Goal: "I can share a small group of things equally onto plates so each plate has the same amount."

Materials: M6_share_plates, M7_sharing_objects_set

1. Minds On (10 mins): Penny's Cookie Problem

Penny baked 8 cookies. She has 2 friends. How can she share so nobody is sad?

Bring children to the carpet. Hold up Penny and 8 paper cookies in a tray.

2. Action (22 mins): Sharing Rounds with Plates

- Send children to small groups of 4.
- Round 2: 'Share 12 grapes fairly between 3 friends.' Children deal onto three plates.
- Round 3 (the leftover round): 'Share 7 grapes fairly between 2 friends.' Children deal one at a time and discover one grape doesn't fit evenly.
- Round 4 (stretch): 'Share 12 grapes fairly between 4 friends.' Each child should end up with 3.
- Class debrief: 'When was sharing easy?'

3. Consolidation (8 mins): Sharing Stories

Discuss:

- Can you tell me about a time you had to share fairly outside school?
- Penny had 9 cookies and 3 friends.
- What is the hardest part of sharing fairly?

Exit: Each child whispers to a partner: 'If I had 10 things and 2 friends, each friend would get ____.' Partners check each other's answers, then walk to the wash-up station.

Lesson 5: Penny, Nickel, Dime, Quarter

Goal: 1¢, 5¢, 10¢, 25¢. The same price can be paid in many coin combinations.

Expectation: A6.13

Learning Goal: "I can name the four Canadian coins and pick coins to pay for snacks priced 5¢, 10¢, or 25¢."

Materials: M1_canadian_coins, M2_estimation_jar, M3_linking_cubes, M5_snack_shop_cards

1. Minds On (8 mins): Quincy's Coin Mystery

Quincy the piggy-bank has a special belly full of coins — and not all of them are the same.

Bring children to the carpet. Hold up Quincy and the estimation jar with mixed coins inside.

2. Action (22 mins): Coin Sort, Coin Match, and the Snack Shop

- Coin Sort station.
- Coin Value Match station.
- Pay-the-Price station with Snack Shop cards (M5).
- Stretch round (only if Step 3 went smoothly): the customer must pay for the snack ANOTHER way.
- Whole-class debrief and summative worksheet.

3. Consolidation (10 mins): Quincy's Closing Song

Discuss:

- Which coin was your favourite to learn?
- Which coin tricked you the most?
- If you had to pay for a 25¢ pizza but you didn't have a quarter, what could you use?
- Outside school, when do you see coins?

Exit: Each child holds up the coin matching what the teacher names: 'Show me a NICKEL.' (Children hold up a nickel.) 'Show me a DIME.' Round through all four.

Name: _____

Date: _____

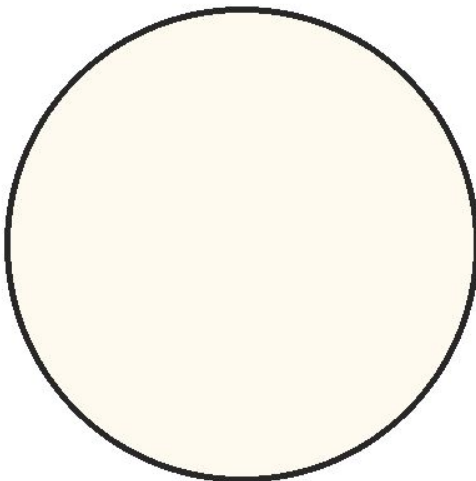
Quincy's Penny Jars

Learning Goal: I can guess how many pennies are in a jar, then count to check, and I can count to 20 starting from any number.

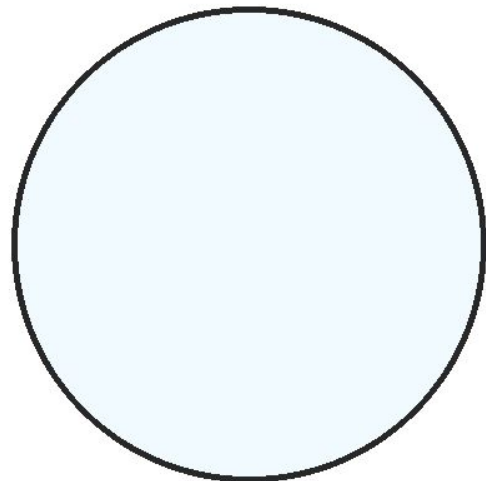
Instructions for the Student:

1. Look at Quincy's first penny jar.
2. Look at Quincy's second penny jar.
3. Penny is at the number 14 on the Coin Path.

My Smart Guess (bigger jar)



GUESS



COUNT

Name: _____

Date: _____

Partners of 5

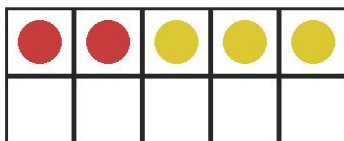
Learning Goal: I can say all the ways to make 5 with two groups, and I can say what is left when I take some away.

Instructions for the Student:

1. Look at each ten-frame.
2. Penny is hiding some cubes under her hand! Look at how many are showing.
3. Colour in two ten-frames to show your own partners of 5.

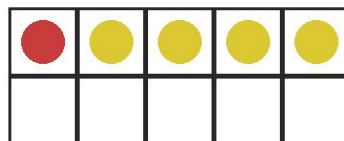
Partners of 5

Way 1



$$2 \text{ red} + 3 \text{ yellow} = 5$$

Way 2



$$1 \text{ red} + 4 \text{ yellow} = 5$$

Name: _____

Date: _____

Snack Shop Story Problems

Learning Goal: I can listen to a snack-shop story, act it out with cubes, and tell how many are altogether or how many are left.

Instructions for the Student:

1. Read each story.
2. Read the story.
3. Look at the equation $6 - 2 = 4$.

Story modelling

START	CHANGE	END

Name: _____

Date: _____

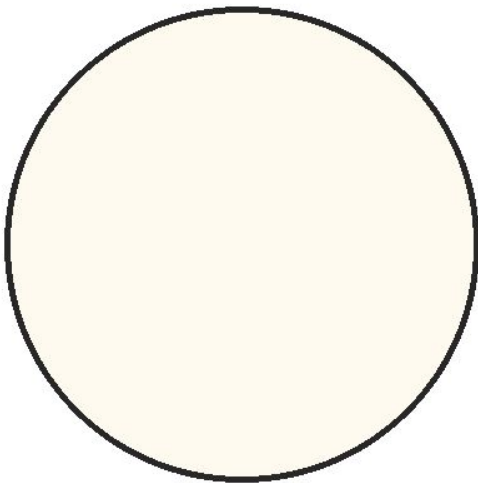
Share It Fair

Learning Goal: I can share a small group of things equally onto plates so each plate has the same amount.

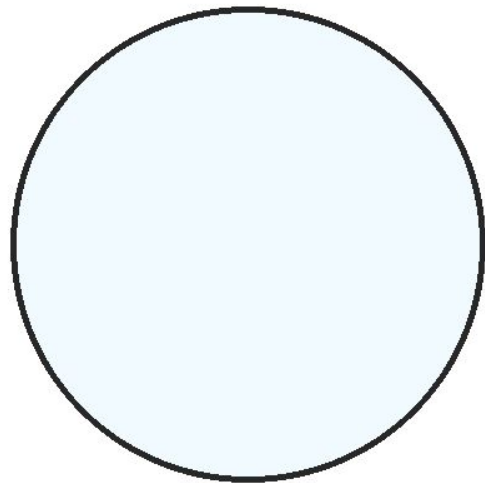
Instructions for the Student:

1. Look at each scene.
2. Some shares don't come out even.
3. Draw your own sharing scene.

My sharing story



Things shared



My share

Name: _____

Date: _____

Coins at the Snack Shop

Learning Goal: I can name the four Canadian coins to 25¢ and tell how much each one is worth, and I can pick coins to pay for a snack priced 5¢, 10¢, or 25¢.

Instructions for the Student:

1. Look at each coin.
2. Three customers want a snack.
3. Penny needs to pay 10¢ for popcorn — but in THREE different ways.

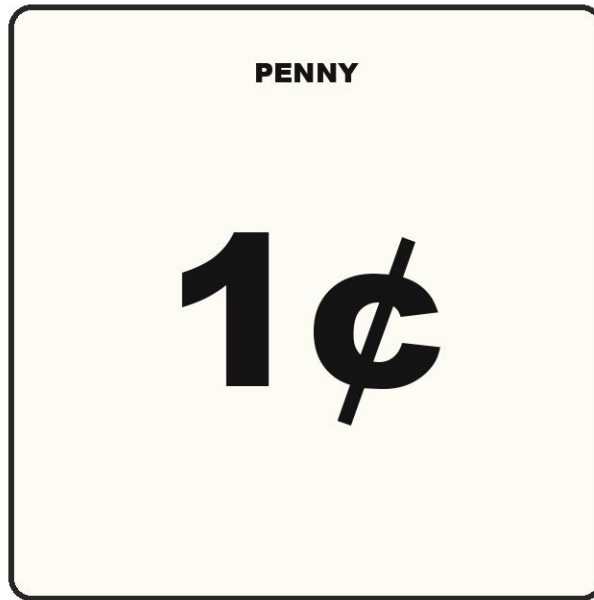
Pay 10¢ three ways

WAY 1	WAY 2	WAY 3

Canadian Coin Set

(M1_canadian_coins)

Per-pair set of real or printed Canadian coins used to identify coin types by colour, size, and embossed image, and to pay for Snack Shop items in Lesson 5.



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 2

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 set per pair

Lessons: 1, 3, 5

Prep: ~25 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 set of 2 pages per pair (10 pairs for a class of 20 = 20 pages).

2. Laminate every page before cutting.

3. Cut along cut-lines.

4. Store each set in a labelled zip-top bag with the coin counts written on the bag.

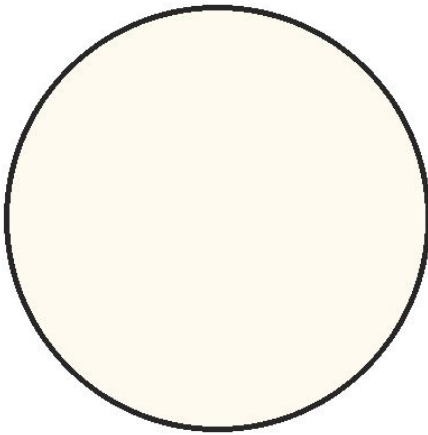
5. Optional: replace printed cards with REAL Canadian coins for Lesson 5.

Estimation Penny Jar

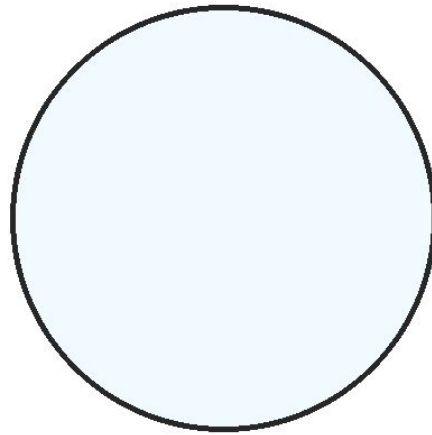
(M2_estimation_jar)

Clear jar with 12-18 pennies inside, used in Lesson 1 for the estimate-then-count routine and revisited in Lesson 5 for Quincy's coin mystery.

Estimation Jar — fill with pennies



My GUESS



Actual COUNT

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 jar template + 1 real jar with pennies for the whole

Lessons: 1, 5

Prep: ~10 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 jar template per classroom (1 page).

2. Laminate the page so it can be re-used across days and classes.

3. Use a real clear plastic jar with 12 pennies on Day 1.

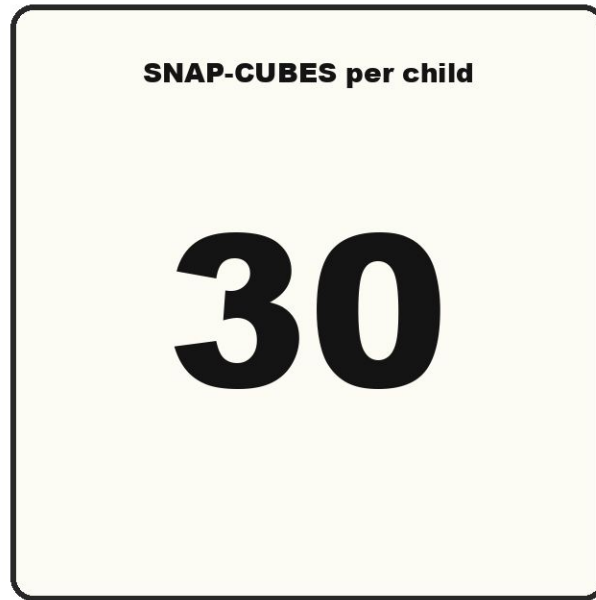
4. Place the jar at the carpet during Minds On for both lessons.

5. Optional: add a sticky note with each child's estimate beside the jar.

Linking Snap-Cubes

(M3_linking_cubes)

30 snap-together cubes per child in 2-3 colours.



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: no

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: ~30 cubes per child

Lessons: 2, 3, 5

Prep: ~15 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Confirm you have ~30 linking snap-cubes per child in your math kit.

2. Sort cubes into 2-3 colours (red and yellow are ideal for partner-of-5 work).

3. Print and cut storage labels; tape one to each child's cube bag.

4. Have cubes ready in bags at the start of Lessons 2, 3, and 5.

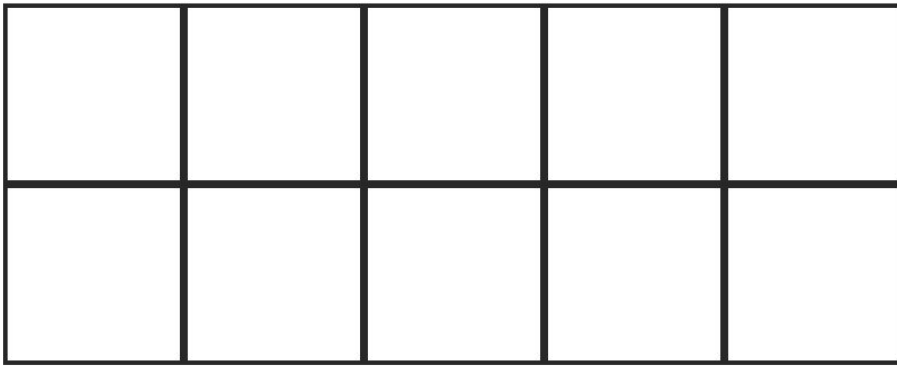
5. Optional.

Ten-Frame Mats

(M4_ten_frames)

Laminated 2x5 grids printed at letter size.

Ten-Frame Mat



Ten-Frame: 2 × 5 cells

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter landscape

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 mat per child

Lessons: 2, 3, 5

Prep: ~20 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 ten-frame mat per child (20 pages for a class of 20).

2. Laminate every page.

3. Stack mats at the math centre.

4. Pair each mat with a small bag of 10 round counters (or borrow cubes from M3 bag).

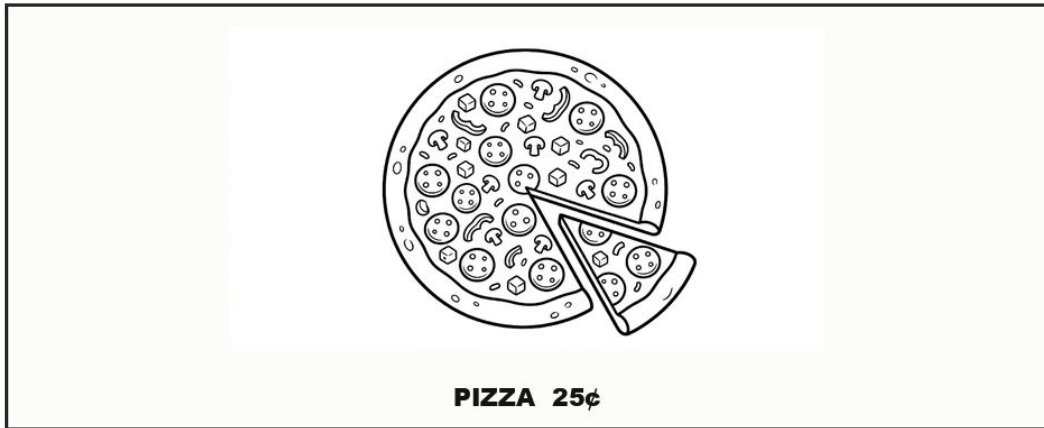
5. Optional.

Snack Shop Price Cards

(M5_snack_shop_cards)

Printable price-tag cards for the Lesson 5 Snack Shop: pizza slice (25¢), popcorn (10¢), lollipop (5¢).

Pizza



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 set of 3 cards per pair

Lessons: 5

Prep: ~18 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 page per pair (10 pages for a class of 20).

2. Laminate every page before cutting.

3. Cut along cut-lines into 3 individual price cards per pair.

4. Tape one card to each Snack Shop station before Lesson 5 starts.

5. Optional.

Sharing Paper Plates

(M6_share_plates)

Set of 4 paper plates per group of 4 children, used in Lesson 4 sharing rounds.

Sharing Paper Plates

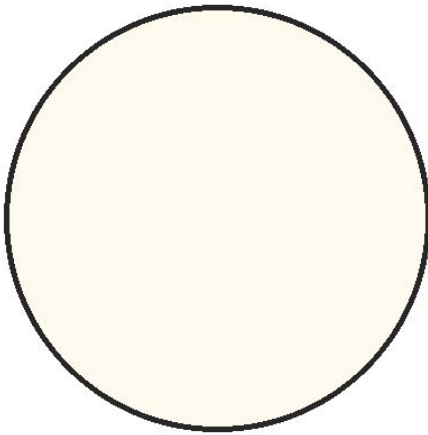


Plate 1

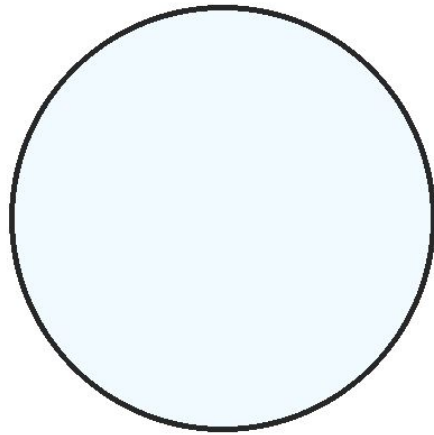


Plate 2

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 set of 4 plates per group of 4

Lessons: 4

Prep: ~12 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 page per group of 4 students (5 pages for a class of 20).

2. Laminate the pages before cutting.

3. Cut along the cut-lines into 4 individual plates per page.

4. Keep all plates flat in a labelled folder.

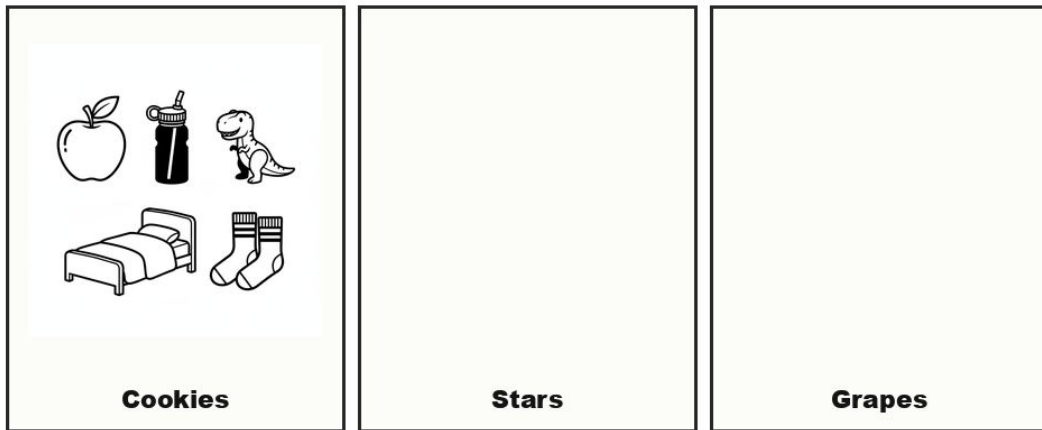
5. Optional.

Sharing Objects Kit

(M7_sharing_objects_set)

24 small classroom objects per group of 4 (wooden counters, paper grapes, paper cookies).

Sharing Objects Kit



PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 set of 24 objects per group of 4

Lessons: 4

Prep: ~15 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 page per group of 4 students (5 pages for a class of 20).

2. Laminate the pages before cutting so the objects can be re-used across multiple lessons.

3. Cut along the cut-lines into 24 individual object icons per group.

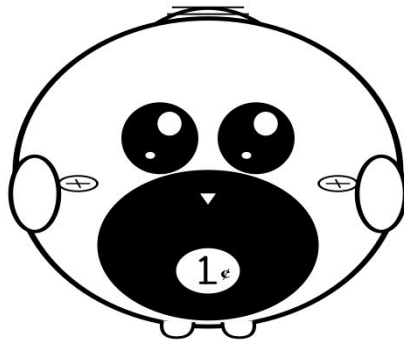
4. Pre-sort the objects into types (cookies, grapes, stars) for the sharing rounds.

5. Optional.

Penny Lead Counter Puppet

(char_penny_puppet)

Printable Penny illustration mounted on a popsicle stick, used as the unit's lead character across all 5 lessons.



Penny the Penny

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 puppet for the teacher

Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~10 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 page on cardstock if possible (or paper + laminate for durability).

2. Cut around the outside of Penny's silhouette including the bottom tab.

3. Glue or tape a popsicle stick behind the bottom tab so Penny can be held up.

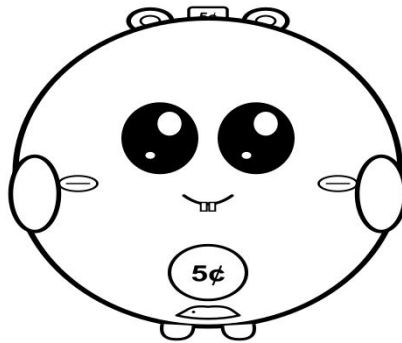
4. Optional: laminate before cutting for years of reuse.

5. Store flat in a folder so the puppet does not crease.

Nick Partner Puppet

(char_nick_puppet)

Printable Nick illustration mounted on a popsicle stick, used as Penny's pair partner across all 5 lessons.



Nick the Nickel

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 puppet for the teacher

Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~10 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 page on cardstock if possible (or paper + laminate for durability).

2. Cut around the outside of Nick's silhouette including the bottom tab.

3. Glue or tape a popsicle stick behind the bottom tab so Nick can be held up.

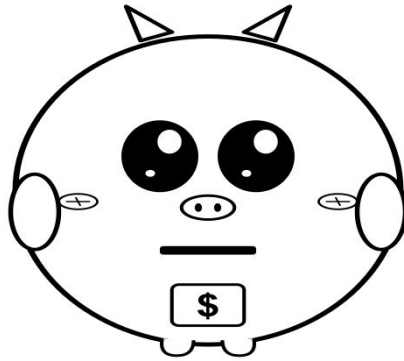
4. Optional: laminate before cutting for years of reuse.

5. Store flat in a folder next to the Penny puppet so they always travel together.

Quincy Piggy Bank Puppet

(char_quincy_puppet)

Printable Quincy piggy-bank cardstock cut-out, propped beside the Snack Shop on Day 5 and appearing in every lesson with a 'how many' speech bubble.



Quincy the Piggy Bank

PRINT SPECS

Size: letter portrait

Colour: bw

Pages per set: 1

Laminate: yes

USE IN CLASS

Quantity: 1 puppet for the teacher

Lessons: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

Prep: ~10 min

TEACHER PREP

1. Print 1 page on cardstock if possible (or paper + laminate for durability).

2. Cut around the outside of Quincy's silhouette including the bottom tab.

3. Glue or tape a popsicle stick behind the bottom tab so Quincy can be held up.

4. Optional: laminate before cutting for years of reuse.

5. Store flat in a folder; bring out for every lesson alongside Penny and Nick.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Summative Assessment Rubric

Expectation	Level 1 (Beginning)	Level 2 (Developing)	Level 3 (Achieving)	Level 4 (Exceeding)
A6.7 estimate the number of objects in small collections and check by counting	With adult prompting, names a number when shown a small collection but the estimate is far from the actual count.	Names an estimate that is sometimes within 5 of the actual; counts to check with support.	Independently estimates within 3 of the actual count and verifies by counting.	Estimates within 2 of the actual; explains the strategy ('I saw a bunch and added a couple more').
A6.8 count to 20 by 1s, starting from any number	Counts to 10 starting from 1; cannot count from any other start.	Counts to 20 starting from 1; counts on from a number with prompting.	Counts to 20 starting from any given number 0-15 without restarting.	Counts to 20 from any start; volunteers count-back from a given number.
A6.9 solve equal-share problems using concrete materials	Distributes objects unevenly; does not check fairness.	Shares evenly when totals divide cleanly; gives up on leftover scenarios.	Deals one at a time, checks each plate; articulates a leftover plan.	Deals fluently; explains why dealing works for any total; offers multiple leftover plans.
A6.10 describe relationships between any two numbers from 0 to 20	Identifies which of two numbers is bigger only with strong adult prompting; cannot articulate the relationship in words.	Identifies bigger / smaller for two numbers within 0-10 with prompting; struggles with numbers 11-20.	Independently describes more, less, equal, or 1-more / 1-less relationships between any two numbers 0-20.	Articulates multiple relationships ('5 is more than 3 AND less than 8 AND 2 less than 7'); spontaneously uses comparison language
A6.11 recall addition facts to 5 and related subtraction facts	Counts to find sums to 5; cannot recall any partner of 5 instantly.	Recalls 1-2 partners of 5 (typically 4+1 or 2+3); counts up for the rest.	Recalls all 6 partners of 5 instantly and connects each + with its related -.	Recalls partners of 5 fluently; extends spontaneously to partners of 6 or 7.
A6.12 solve situations involving addition and subtraction to 10 using concrete materials	Models the start with materials but cannot decide which operation; guesses.	Chooses correctly when keywords are obvious; struggles with 'altogether' vs 'left'.	Listens to a story, picks the right operation, models with cubes or coins, writes the equation.	Maps story to operation fluently; writes the equation before modelling; explains the keyword cue.
A6.13 identify and explore the value of Canadian coins to 25¢ and coins and bills to \$10	Names some coins by colour but mixes up the dime and nickel; does not yet attach values.	Names the four coins reliably; states the value when prompted with the chart.	Names all four coins on sight, states their values without the chart, and pays for a 5¢/10¢/25¢ snack with a single matching coin.	Pays for a price multiple ways using coin combinations (e.g., 10¢ as 2 nickels OR 1 dime); explains why combinations are

Junior Counting Crew Certificate

This certificate is proudly presented to:

For successfully completing the 5-Day Coin Counters unit and demonstrating the skills of a Counting Crew chef. Penny and Nick, and Quincy the piggy-bank, congratulate the student and welcome them to the next adventure in numbers and money.

By completing this unit, this student has demonstrated:

- Estimating a small collection and checking by counting
- Counting to 20 starting from any number
- Recalling partners of 5 and connecting addition with subtraction
- Solving snack-shop story problems to 10
- Sharing fairly using the deal strategy
- Naming the four Canadian coins to 25¢ and paying with the right...

Marketplace Listing

A 5-day Ontario Kindergarten unit on Number Sense and Operations (A6.7-A6.13), framed around Penny and Nick, two child-chef Coin Counters running a classroom snack shop, with Quincy the smiling piggy bank cheering them on.

Price: \$9.99 CAD

Pages: ~38

Classroom time: 200 min

Teacher prep: ~95 min

Top tags: kindergarten, math, ontario-curriculum, number-sense, operations, estimation, coins, money

What's included:

- 5 fully-scripted lesson plans (40-50 minutes each, ~225 minutes of total teaching time)
- 5 student worksheets aligned to each lesson, with name/date fields and child-voice learning goals
 - 1 mid-unit formative assessment (Numerals 0-10 Check-In) administered between Lessons 3 and 4
 - 10 printable teacher manipulatives: Canadian coin set, estimation jar template, snap-cubes label, ten-frame mat, Snack Shop price cards, sharing paper plates,...
 - 1 end-of-unit reflection sheet with 5 self-assessment prompts
 - 4 class observation trackers: 1 diagnostic (Lesson 1) + 3 formative (Lessons 2, 3, 4)
 - 1 six-row summative rubric covering A6.7-A6.13 across 4 levels (Beginning, Developing, Achieving, Exceeding)
 - 1 summative-administration guide tying the rubric to Lesson 5 worksheet, the lesson, and the rubric, together for the teacher
 - Junior Counting Crew certificate (one per child) for the closing ceremony, featuring Penny, Nick, and Quincy
 - Detailed expanded walkthrough for the keystone lesson (Lesson 3 — Snack Shop Story Problems), including the side-by-side dime-vs-nickel recovery move for the...
 - Differentiation tracks built into every lesson: emerging learners, extending learners, ELL/IEP, and movement-first learners